📝 Notes

Feb 5, 2026

toby merker and John Miranda

Invited John Miranda Toby Merker

Attachments toby merker and John Miranda

Meeting records Transcript Recording

Summary

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker, Supply Chain Manager at Liquid Medlock, provided an overview of the company's focus on child-resistant and compliant packaging for the pharmaceutical and cannabis industries, noting the company's Canadian base and current expansion into the US methadone treatment market. Merker described the end-to-end workflow, which uses a CRM synced with QuickBooks for inventory management and custom 'container' and 'purchase order' apps to track inventory, items "on the water," and run rates, despite challenges with manual human errors in data input. Merker, John Miranda, and Safwan discussed the difficulty of automating the upload of varied warehouse WMS reports and tracking data to the CRM for automatic invoice generation, and Merker requested a feature to capture customer-specific delivery instructions within the CRM's ship-to addresses.

Details

- **Introduction to Liquid Medlock and Product Offerings** Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker, the Supply Chain Manager at Liquid Medlock, provided an overview of the company, which is a medical compliant packaging company specializing in child-resistant and compliance-related packaging solutions for the pharmaceutical industry. Liquid Medlock primarily sells cannabis-related packaging like dram jars, pouches, and pre-roll tubes, as well as child-resistant packaging for addiction treatment centers for methadone dispersement across

Canada and the US (00:00:00). Toby Merker clarified that the company does not own the factories but works closely with them, often finding customers for custom products and having them manufactured (00:01:13).

- **Market Operations and Expansion** Liquid Medlock is a Canadian-based company, with the majority of their sales coming from Canada, though they have initiated a push into the US market over the last 12 to 18 months to capture market share in methadone addiction treatment clinics south of the border (00:01:13). Toby Merker confirmed that they are gaining traction and moving toward rapid expansion in the US if the current trend continues (00:02:06). Toby Merker noted that in the US, they are setting up order processing differently using a self-serve Shopify web-based platform, and they are considering if this model will eventually be used in Canada (00:04:22).
- **End-to-End Order Workflow** Toby Merker outlined the end-to-end workflow, which begins with the customer contacting them and the order being entered as a sales order in their CRM (00:02:06). The CRM order follows workflows to be sent to the warehouse for distribution and packaging; the warehouse coordinates shipment details, ships the order, and the information is uploaded back to the CRM. An invoice is then generated through QuickBooks and submitted to the customer (00:03:12). The CRM is synced with QuickBooks, allowing for daily updates on active inventory, which sales teams use to confirm product availability (00:04:22).
- **CRM Customizations for Inventory Management and Visibility** Liquid Medlock implemented customizations primarily to gain visibility through the CRM, as sales representatives previously relied on daily reports from warehouses, leading to frequent questions about available stock (00:05:20). The integration of the CRM with QuickBooks ties inventory data to specific warehouses, providing the available quantity as of the morning's QuickBooks count (00:06:15). Another major customization was the development of a 'container app' and a 'purchase order app' on the CRM to track items, quantities, arrival dates, and shipping documents for shipments coming from China (00:07:09).
- **Integrated Inventory Tracking and Run Rate Calculations** The custom container app and purchase order app allow for real-time updates of quantities and units ordered from China, and this data ties into the inventory page to show current stock, items 'on the water,' and open purchase orders (00:07:09). Additionally, the inventory tab includes run rates that provide 12-month sales figures, replenishment time, and triggers email notifications to prompt orders for low-stock items (00:08:30). Toby Merker stated that they are fully integrated with

the CRM across the entire supply chain management, ordering, and item visibility (00:09:31).

- **Challenges and Human Errors in Inventory Management** Toby Merker identified human error as the sole remaining issue in their streamlined process, citing mistakes in inputting warehouse codes (a one-letter difference) or keying in incorrect receipt quantities (e.g., 10,000 instead of 100,000 units) as examples of errors that cause inventory misalignment and require manual tracking to resolve (00:09:31). Inventory reconciliation, which they currently perform once a year, is a manual process involving reviewing documents, transactions, and communicating with the warehouse, followed by manual stock adjustments in the system (00:11:44). While the accountant wants to increase reconciliation frequency, Toby Merker successfully negotiated a semi-annual schedule (00:12:42).
- **Warehouse WMS and Data Integration** Liquid Medlock uses four separate warehouse locations, all of which now utilize WMS software for electronic scanning and tracking to reduce human errors. Toby Merker stated that the company prefers their own inventory tracking and order system (Method CRM) to be separate from the warehouses' WMS to ensure accurate and independent tracking (00:12:42) (00:14:50). John Miranda noted that the company heavily uses sales orders and purchase orders, and Toby Merker clarified that they typically sell full cases and do not engage in pick and pack services, but rather just picking (00:15:41).
- **Shipment Processing and Automation Limitations** After an order is packed by the warehouse, the company secures the best shipping rate, sometimes involving spot rate quotes (00:15:41). Once shipped, the warehouses manually send paperwork or reports to Liquid Medlock, who then manually uploads the data (including tracking numbers) into the CRM to generate invoices (00:16:35). Toby Merker and Safwan determined that fully automating the upload of Excel files from the warehouses into the CRM for invoice generation was not possible due to integration complexities and the varying formats from four different warehouses (00:17:31) (00:19:17).
- **Role of the Supply Chain Manager and System Use** Toby Merker stated that as the Supply Chain Manager, they manage the entire company's day-to-day operations and supply chain without any issues, finding the current process streamlined (00:20:09). Toby Merker manages the entire order process from "birth to death," with the exception of collecting and posting payments, which the

accountant handles (00:21:14). Toby Merker confirmed that Method CRM is the source of truth for day-to-day operations and inventory, backed up by the WMS reports from the warehouses, noting a conflict with the accountant who relies on QuickBooks as the ledger (00:22:07).

- **Method CRM Inventory Solution Discussion** John Miranda provided background that Method is developing a native inventory solution, which was informed by customizations made for Liquid Medlock. John Miranda asked if Toby Merker would be interested in testing the new general solution, which is aimed at small to mid-size businesses (00:24:05). Toby Merker expressed doubt that any general solution would match the niche, integrated, and custom-coded features they already created with Safwan, which took months of work and debugging (00:25:05).
- **Desired CRM Improvements and Final Requests** Toby Merker identified the only desired change with a "magic wand" would be the automated uploading of the end-of-day shipped out documents from the four separate warehouses to the CRM, and the subsequent automatic generation of an invoice (00:27:59). The other feature Toby Merker requested from Safwan is a space within the customer ship-to addresses to easily capture customer-specific delivery requests and notes (like "needs a tailgate" or "deliver before 2 p.m.") that would pre-populate when creating a sales order for that destination (00:28:51). John Miranda concluded the call by thanking Toby Merker and requesting permission to send a survey on inventory management features to inform 2026 development, which Toby Merker agreed to .

Suggested next steps

- [ ] John Miranda will send the survey to Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker right now.
- [ ] John Miranda will send Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker a quick five-minute survey regarding the priorities of different inventory management features.

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📖 Transcript

Feb 5, 2026

toby merker and John Miranda - Transcript

00:00:00

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: This call is now being transcribed. Now taking notes. This call is now being
John Miranda: All right, cool.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: recorded.
John Miranda: So, um, uh, I guess the best way to get started is just to learn more about yourself, um, the company, uh, what Liquid Liquid Medlock, uh, Medlock does, um, the industry that they're in, the products that they sell, and who they sell to.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh well, I'm the supply chain manager at Liquid Medlock. I handle uh distribution, shipments, order processing, day-to-day operations, and all of that pertaining all that that pertains to uh Liquid Medlock. We are a medical compliant packaging company. So we have childresistant and compliance related packaging solutions for various uh customers in the pharmaceutical industry. In particular uh we sell cannabis related packaging products, drram jars, pouches, tubes for pre-rolls. We sell um what's the best phrase?

00:01:13

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: uh child resistant packaging uh for addiction treatment centers for methadone dispersement
John Miranda: That's it.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: across Canada and the US. Uh that is our primary uh those are our primary products and what Liquid Medlock does.
John Miranda: Uh, so do you guys also produce your own packaging or you just sell it and distribute
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh we work closely with our factories. We don't own the factories uh but we have some proprietary stuff.
John Miranda: it.

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh most of it is uh finding customers for custom products and having it made for them.
John Miranda: Makes sense. And uh when I was uh on your website, I re I noticed that you guys have multiple distribution centers. Like you're you guys are a Canadian-owned company, but you primarily operate within the US market. Is that
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: No, you're on our US website if that's what you're seeing.
John Miranda: correct?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: We are a Canadian-based company.

00:02:06

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh the majority of our sales come from Canada. Um we have initiated a I don't know if it's strong, but we have initiated a push into the US uh to start um trying to capture market share in methadone addiction treatment clinics as well south of the border uh for the last 12 to 18 months. And we are, I would say, gaining traction and moving towards expanding fairly quickly if it goes the way it's supposed to.
John Miranda: that's awesome. Um, so like uh about this whole supply chain, right? So could you walk me through like the endtoend workflow um from an order is placed to the time that you get paid like every sing as much detail that you could provide on how that workflow looks like end to
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I'm not uh well the customer will contact us.
John Miranda: end
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: We'll enter the order on uh CRM. Uh it follows the workflows created to get sent to our warehouse for distributing and packaging.

00:03:12

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Um, warehouse will either coordinate shipment details or packing details. Uh, ship it out. Uh, we upload the information that it's shipped out back to CRM, generate an invoice that goes through QuickBooks and then gets submitted out to the customers.
John Miranda: Gotcha. So, um when you get that order, is it a sales order um that starts out on the

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Well, it can be a SA.
John Miranda: CRM?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: It will start out as a sales order. Yes. Uh, a lot of times we're using um CRM to hold our pending orders through sales leads and purchase orders. So, a customer might say, "Yeah, I want 10,000 units for the next six months." So, our sales team will put in an order into what we have set up as a pending dropdown where those six separate shipments are created and then we go in and move them over once the customer says, "Yeah, please ship. Please process um or the customer will email us today and say we want this order um please ship it out." So,

00:04:22

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: we enter the order in and it go and it goes again through the workflows to be processed. In the States, we're setting it up differently. Um, where it's a lot more self-s served through a Shopify web-based platform. Um, I don't know if we're going to eventually move to that in Canada for order processing. Um, it's a lot different in how shipments are handled is causing some different methods being used versus Canada and the US.
John Miranda: Gotcha. So typically you have like a uh a B2B another business ordering whatever amount of quantity of this packaging um for methodon products. um the sales team puts in um an order for um x amount of quantities and then after that um would you have to confirm with your like your warehouse uh that you have that much available to actually sell to this customer at any point in
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: uh CRM is synced with our QuickBooks and we have active inventory when we're placing the order.

00:05:20

John Miranda: time.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: We can see what's available real time. Well, with daily,
John Miranda: That's awesome.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I won't say real time. It's every morning it gets updated.
John Miranda: Gotcha. So you guys use QBDT,

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh I we are using QB.
John Miranda: right?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I believe it's the online version, but I'm not
John Miranda: Nice.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: sure.
John Miranda: Okay. Because I know Safone was mentioning how he worked with you a lot to implement a lot of inventory management workflows.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yep.
John Miranda: Okay. And uh what were like the primary uh problems that you were trying to solve with these customizations um that you that you envisioned and now you guys
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh two main things that we wanted was visibility through CRM because we were getting
John Miranda: have
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: daily reports from our warehouses.

00:06:15

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Um or the other warehouse we have in Bmpton. I do have real time live access to it. Um but sales did not. So sales was coming and going do we have this, do we have that? or sales was copied on reports and having to pull them up. Um, and I don't know if you've dealt with anybody in sales, they're not always great at reports and Excel or data. So, um, there would always be questions. So the one work, the one change we made um was tying in CRM to our inventory with QuickBooks so that when you type in the product at a specific warehouse, it will tell you the available quantity as of this morning's QuickBooks count. So that was one step that was made. Um that that was like I don't even know at what point that was implemented.

00:07:09

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: That was towards the end because the main function that was started with CRM after the order placement was uh with our container uh containers and shipments coming from China. We needed a database to track items, track quantities, track arrival dates, track shipping documents. Um, and if you have access to our portal, if you click on our container app, um, there's an active container

and a delivered container, but that entire app was customdesigned for us to track all of our products and our purchase orders. And that container app ties into a purchase order app that is also on CRM. so that when I send a purchase order over to China, the quantities and units that we've ordered ordered is real time updated. Um, but that ties over to our inventory page to say you have 150,000 of these units, you have 50,000 more on the water and you have an open PO of a 100,000 still to be made and still to ship.

00:08:30

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So by utilizing and integrating these things and like the end vision is what I had in my head when I started but it was like we do this step then we do this step then we do this step and Safon and I went back and forth and um one of the difficulties that I think a lot of people have including uh my boss and owner is they see something in their head as a final vision But it's going to take you six or seven steps to get there. And if you don't know which steps to take, you're going to be stumbling and kicking and getting angry and frustrated over it taking too long. So, um, for me, it was designing the container app. It was coordinating QuickBooks and matching the inventory codes. Um, and then we even have a piece on our inventory tab that gives us run rates now. um as the last piece that says these items you have on hand.

00:09:31

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: This is your 12 month sales. This is how long it takes you to replenish it. And I get an email that says you need to look at these items. Do you need to order more? So like we're fully integrated with CRM in our entire um supply chain management, ordering our orders um our visibility on our items and the only issue that we have found so far is humans. So, every time a human makes a mistake either in a quantity or in a skew code or listing an item incorrectly or ordering the wrong thing, errors happen. And um if I could remove the humans, it would be great.
John Miranda: Yeah. Um,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah.
John Miranda: could you is do you have like any specific example of like when that's happened and like the impact that had on
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah.

John Miranda: your business?

00:10:28

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So it's very very simple in fact is uh we get a container of items and we have a code that marks it that it's going to a G warehouse or to our BMPon warehouse and it's one letter difference. So when you're inputting the wrong letter code for the warehouse it'll say we have units in G when they're supposed to be and actually in Bmpton. And then when you're processing orders, QuickBooks will then say, "Oh, you don't have this item on hand." And you're like, "No, no, I know I do." And then you have to go and track down the problem. Um, or similarly, again, data entry error where an item comes in and you key in that we received 10,000, but we actually received a 100,000 and now things don't align and you're missing inventory. Um, and it's the the errors that I have come across or the issues that I've come across like we're just completing our inventory reconciliation for last year and we're going through it um because we're trying to make sure that a the warehouse doesn't lose goods and b we can track all of our inventory and all of our items and every single error and misalignment is due to some kind of human error.

00:11:44

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Every single one. So, our warehouse is coming to us and saying, "No, we shipped out this much on this date, and here's the orders, and that's the quantity we're supposed to have." And then me and Rey, our accountant, go back and look through our inventory and our orders, and it's like, "Oh, yeah, this order was coded wrong, or oh yeah, this order, uh, the quantities didn't match, or it was said it shipped out of the US when it shipped out of G." So, like it's all human errors um that drive all of our headaches and then spending time to fix them. Um I'm at the point where on our inventory reconciliation, we've done all of the leg work and tracked down 99.9% of the issues. Um manual adjustment,
John Miranda: Mhm.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: make the counts match. I don't want to talk about it anymore.
John Miranda: Yeah. I was just going to ask like uh what's the process of actually fixing it?

00:12:42

John Miranda: And it sounds like it's a whole manual process going through all the documents, the transactions, talking to your warehouse, and then doing these manual stock adjustments to ensure that inventory is reflected correctly.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah,
John Miranda: Right.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: because we only do it once a year and it's part of your job. So,
John Miranda: Okay.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: if it takes you a day or it takes you two days to make sure that you're not missing,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: you know, $10,000 worth of stock, like fine. Um, but yeah, that's exactly what it is. You have to go through and and check your inventory. And, uh, our accountant wants to do it monthly. I laughed at her and said, "Never." Um, and so we're on a twice a year schedule where in July we'll do it again. Um, and it's essentially tracking down errors that we make that um, the good part is that both of our warehouses at this time are using WMS software that um, they're scanning and tracking electronically and essentially removing the human errors.

00:13:41

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, their records at this point, um, I won't say are 100% because they if they picked the wrong box or they shipped the wrong thing, like that can still happen. But, um, we went through this entire reconciliation and our warehouses located items that were missing, told us they were missing, and are compensating us for them. and we have been unable to verify any other discrepancies by spending hours of time going through it. So, um yeah,
John Miranda: Oh
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: like that it's annoying. It's once a year and it's over now.
John Miranda: yeah.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: It's February what 5th and we're finishing it off

um from end of year 2025. We had vacations and time offs and this and that, but whatever. So,
John Miranda: No, but at the end of the day, it's still frustrating. like you would want hope to have a software that you know maybe one day catches these errors for you and you know intervenes and reconciles and ensures that your is as accurate as it should be like that's I think that's like the blue sky like you know you would wish that that would happen that way.

00:14:50

John Miranda: Uh, and you mentioned that you have a your warehouses have a WMS system, but that doesn't uh like communicate with the CRM,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: No, we don't want it to communicate with the CRM.
John Miranda: right?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: We want to have our own tracking of our inventory and orders separate from the warehouses for a bunch of reasons. um we want it to be as accurate as possible, but like we can't rely on a warehouse to say, "Oh, no, you're not missing anything." Right? So,
John Miranda: makes sense. Uh, do you know how many warehouses you operate out
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: uh, we have four separate locations at the
John Miranda: of? Gotcha.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: moment.
John Miranda: Okay. And um I So I just want to go back to like the workflow, right? So you guys use sales orders a lot. You guys use purchase orders a lot. Do you guys also have like a order like a pick pack process that I assume this happens at the warehouse,

00:15:41

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh,
John Miranda: right?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: we I'm not sure what you mean. Pick pack
John Miranda: Um basically like uh when an order is placed and then when it's ready to be like shipped,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: process.

John Miranda: you have all the uh quantities available. um like the warehouse or whichever persona would you know pick all the items uh pack it into a container or box and then ship it to the customer. Is that the type of workflow that you guys
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh yeah, but we don't do any pick and packing.
John Miranda: do?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: We just do picking generally. We don't um we don't unpack a box and repack it. We sell full cases. So that's where my uh so order goes to the warehouse,
John Miranda: Okay.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: they pack it up. Uh depending on the depending on the customer, there could be pre-arranged carriers where it's the order is ready for pickup and the carrier gets arranged right away.

00:16:35

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: And then other locations and customers require spot rate quotes on shipments. So the warehouse will be like, "This order is ready. Please schedule pickup. Here's the dimensions." And then we source the best rate um or quickest
John Miranda: Mhm.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: or whatever option is best for that shipment to go out and get picked up and
John Miranda: Gotcha.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: scheduled.
John Miranda: And when you do secure that best rate and it does get shipped out, um, is there any way that you get that shipping information into the
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah. At the end of the day, we get a it's manual where end of the day the the warehouses are sending
John Miranda: CRM?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: us the paperwork or the reports saying these orders have shipped and we are uploading that data into CRM and then generating invoices um double-checking that the right ship items have been shipped and generating the invoices manually.

00:17:31

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I've had conversations about uploading it and having it automated from the warehouses and Safwan and I got to the point where no this is not something possible yet.
John Miranda: Okay. And he mentioned it's not possible just because of the state of or met the CRM like the software,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh yeah, integrating the Excel file from the warehouse in the fields to match
John Miranda: right?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: to make sure it lines up to then generate an invoice is not something that it was capable at. the last time we had talked, which is fine because I want to have eyes on it anyway to make sure everything's shipped out properly. That's one of my primary functions until I'm
John Miranda: No,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: replaced.
John Miranda: for sure. And um uh but I guess that's something that would be like a nice to have like if that if that feature was there, it would solve like the this uh this pain of just know manually doing it, I assume.

00:18:26

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh yeah, we generally only have, you know, five to 10 at the most shipments a day. So it's 5 to 10 minutes that you're uploading this shipped out. These are the items. Here's the tracking number. Generate invoice. So it is a simple mindless job, but um it doesn't take a lot of time. It's not like we're um like in the US we're set up through Shopify um specifically because the customers are ordering and we're shipping it with one carrier and it's cases at a time, not skids, not special shipments, not pick and packs. Um so all of that is automated where the warehouse ships it out. Um it gets back to Shopify and then invoice gets created. So, um I know how we could do it, but not with our products and not how it's set up in Canada as it is.

00:19:17

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: It would be a complete business model

change if we were to switch over and do it and based
John Miranda: Makes sense.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: on what Safon was saying. And the other thing is we have four different warehouses with four different W's, four different reporting teams. So to get them all to come back into CRM with a properly formatted file that matches the fields that updates what we want that requires zero human
John Miranda: Mhm.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: oversight. That's you know I don't see that happening anytime soon. The hours SL once said it would take doesn't justify the 5 to 10 minutes of work.
John Miranda: 100%. And um other than like the whole like process of like reconciliation and um others like is there any other processes in your workflow in method CRM today that takes a lot of time out of your
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: not from mine.
John Miranda: day?

00:20:09

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh, as a supply chain and dealing with the daily ops, I don't have any issues um with the dayto-day. It's streamlined. I like it. if I don't like it or want something, I usually message and and um having a small background in webpage design and and being old and experienced, I kind of know what is doable and what isn't. So, I know when to push and when I can. Um, I know that Jack and sales are pushing for a whole bunch of integrated sales, um, follow-ups, leads, uh, marketing pushes, a whole bunch of things that, um, I I don't really care if they do or if they don't, but I see it taking a lot of time and energy. Um, and, uh, in the day-to-day operations and supply chain, I don't have any issues right now. Nope.
John Miranda: Okay. And uh you mentioned like you use you find like the entire process very streamlined.

00:21:14

John Miranda: Um are there any other like personas like which other types of individuals at at your company work at use the method serum like that workflow you described earlier? Is it just

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I am the entire company.
John Miranda: you?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So you're learn you will learn that. Yes.
John Miranda: Okay. So you're you're the man who from the order all the way to getting paid. You you man that entire process on
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: birth to death.
John Miranda: method.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh the only thing I don't do is collect the payments and post them to the account.
John Miranda: Okay. That's where I guess the accounting comes in and
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Uh yeah,
John Miranda: everything.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: she like I'll send her the um create invoice process and it goes out to the customer, but once that's done um she collects money, she posts money, she's tracking revenue and all that. Like I don't care about that.

00:22:07

John Miranda: Interesting. Okay, cool. Um, one thing I did have a question about was um, you mentioned how you guys use QBO and QBO has its own like quantity on hand for inventory items, right? Um, and you mentioned that that syncs with method CRM,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: daily in the morning around 11:00 a.m.
John Miranda: right? Okay. And then um your quantities also get uh they get impacted by um
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yep.
John Miranda: shipments uh deliveries as well as receiving from purchase orders. So um all these impacts also transition to QVO right sync birectionally.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Think birectionally. I don't care what goes back to QBO if that's what you're asking.
John Miranda: Okay. Okay.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So,
John Miranda: Okay. So method is a source of truth for all your inventory at all times.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: uh, method is the source of truth for day-to-day operations and inventory. Yes.

00:23:02

Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Um, however, uh, as as God is a source of truth, my WMS reports from my warehouses are my backup.
John Miranda: Gotcha. Okay. Okay. Makes sense.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, our our accountant wants to use QuickBooks as our um as our ledger
John Miranda: Um
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: and this is the beall and endall and I have learned due to human error and data entry and back and forth invoicing issues. know that like I know that you want to use that as an accountant for your inventory and trust it, but I've already learned over many years now that my reports from my warehouses are gospel until I do an inventory reconcile once a year and we're off by, you know, shrinkage of less than 0.1%. Like whatever. like our account wants to use QuickBooks and I don't care about QuickBooks. So, I guess we're always going to bang

00:24:05

John Miranda: No, I I I totally hear you.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: heads.
John Miranda: So a little background is um methods currently building out like a native inventory solution and uh your company was one of the companies that we actually uh I talked to SAF one about a year ago to look identify like how did your company actually you know implement inventory which which were the types of features that were really important to you guys and um we're close to launching it and it's basically a native solution that we track uh committed expected available we have locations uh we have um item location linking uh from the entire fulfillment for so sales orders and purchase orders and eventually we're going to um tie that in with bills and uh invoices as well for payment. So um just want to say that like um if you guys ever want to be part of inventory testing like um would you guys be interested in that?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I don't know what more you would be doing for than what we've already created. So,

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John Miranda: Oh yeah. No, I I already know our solution won't,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: sure.
John Miranda: you know, satisfy you guys because you're you it's a it's very niche solution that that's for your business, right? This is more of a general solution for anyone who's looking for any um any uh native inventory solution for their company. It's typically for the smaller to mid-size businesses is what we're uh looking to build. But um just wanted to let you know that something like that is coming along the lines and um your the customizations on your account actually played a part of like the discovery process in the
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah,
John Miranda: early stages.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: that's uh good to hear and I'm glad that you you were able to use it. I can tell you that building it out with Safon was um I don't want to say fun, but it was at least not wasn't at least the it wasn't the worst thing ever. So, um, and now that and I knew that starting it and doing it and, um, like I said, you had to have a whole bunch of steps to do to finish it and get it to where we are today, but I knew that once we were done, it would be worth it.

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Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, yeah, we spent, you know, weeks and months um, here's a step, here's a step, here's what I need tied in here. And it was, okay, this is broken, this doesn't work, change it. So it really took like months and months to get to the point where we could say this is working and doing what we want and then of course as soon as we get everything to where we want uh the owner and the boss or the sales VP at the time would be like oh well what about this and it's like you know like okay like thanks that's that's another month of work you know I I hear you. Um, but it's good to hear that, you know, our efforts have led to something that's beneficial for you. And like I said, I don't think that anything you would roll out today would do everything that we're currently doing for our business because I know that we've integrated so many little pieces and codes and track this and track that and upload and we've worked through all of those bugs.

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Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, feel free to reach out if if you want uh me to break something for you.
John Miranda: 100% sure
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Actually, if you if you ever want anything broken,
John Miranda: 100%
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I have a sales rep for you. That's that's what I
John Miranda: that sales will be perfect right now.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: got.
John Miranda: We're just doing a bunch of testing before we go live. So, we're just catching a bunch of uh bugs right now. But uh that's good to know and uh maybe one day I'll reach out regarding that sales rep.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah, Ran Randy can break anything,
John Miranda: Um one last question.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: trust me. So,
John Miranda: That's awesome. That's awesome. Um, one last question before we end off the call is that um, if you could like, this is a hypothetical question, but if you could like wave a magic wand, uh, what's one thing that you would want changed about method and how that works for you um, to improve your

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Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: uh it's not possible.
John Miranda: experience?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, uh, we we've already talked about it where, um, the end of day shipped out documents from the warehouse, I would like them to automatically upload and if not automatically generate an invoice, be like, everything's uploaded and done and look at it before I hit the invoice. Um, that would be that's the only thing. So, I can tell you that from my one warehouse in G,
John Miranda: Yeah.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: I get an Excel file every night at like 11:00 at night that says, "Here's all the orders that shipped out. Here's the lot numbers, here's the items, here's the tracking, here's the orders." Um, and then I literally just open the Excel file and then upload one by one into CRM. And I know that there is a way to drop that file somewhere or send it somewhere and have CRM upload it.

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Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: But we have to map each field perfectly. It has to align perfectly. Um, and then there's three other warehouses that would all have to f do the same exact format. Um, and then still I'd have to double check it before it would be done. So that's the only thing that I would like to have integrated that I can think of off the top of my head.
John Miranda: Yeah.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Um, I did have an email out to Saffwan that um,
John Miranda: Heat.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: the one other thing that I can give you that he probably already has on his agenda is in our specific customer ship to addresses. We are having customerspecific delivery requests and items. There's nowhere to capture those items easily for each shipment location.
John Miranda: Okay.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: So, I want to be able to go into Shoppers Drug Mart, Shoppers Drug Mart Monton, and say, "This location needs a tailgate. This location delivers before 2 p.m.,

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Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: this location needs specific items only." And even if it's only
John Miranda: Mhm.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: 280 characters or 200 characters of notes that I could type in for each ship to address that when I then go into ordering an item or creating a sales order, it gives me that box that's prepopulated and I can save and overwrite it on every order if I need to, but it's always there for that destination.
John Miranda: Gotcha. Gotcha. Wow,
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Yeah,
John Miranda: that would be very useful.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: that's why I've asked for it. So, we'll see what Safan

John Miranda: Amazing. But, uh, Toby, thanks you so much for your time.
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: says.
John Miranda: Really appreciate the discussion, the insights. These are incredibly valuable. Um, is it cool if I send you over a quick like five minute survey?
Toby “Super Gaming Family Fun” Merker: Sure. Okay. Thank you. Have a good day.

Transcription ended after 00:31:36

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